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DE-STRESS
PM Modi at the fifth edition of 'Pariksha Pe Charcha' in New Delhi, Apr. 1

BJP/ PM NARENDRA MODI

PM MODI AS HEADMASTER

By Anilesh S. Mahajan

On April 1, Prime Minister Narendra Modi held a townhall meeting at the national capital's Talkatora Stadium with 1,000-odd students gearing up to take secondary school exams. Modelled on 'Chai Pe Charcha', Modi's video outreach to adult audiences, the programme is called 'Pariksha Pe Charcha' and has been an annual event since 2018. From students to beneficiaries of social sector schemes, from party MPs and cadre to bureaucrats and officials, it's unlikely the country has seen a prime minister who likes to engage directly—and visibly—with so many social groupings. Nehru, of course, did so...but that was the pre-amplification era, so the 'Modi effect' is all-new.

From explaining the benefits of central schemes to beneficiaries to